HOORVIA - BAKING TROUBLESHOOTING CHART (CAKES, COOKIES & BREAD)

Quick Reference Cheat Sheet · US Letter Printable

Kitchen & Cooking

Cake Sinks in the Dead Center	
Primary Chemical / Oven Cause	**How to Prevent It Next Time**
Too much leavening, underbaked core, or oven door opened early	Measure baking powder level; bake to 200°F / 93°C internal; don't peek before 25 min

High Cracked Volcano Dome	
Primary Chemical / Oven Cause	**How to Prevent It Next Time**
Oven too hot OR too much flour (crust sets before center rises)	Spoon & level flour (120g/cup); lower temp -25°F / -32°C; use wet cake strips

Dry, Crumbly & Coarse Crumb	
Primary Chemical / Oven Cause	**How to Prevent It Next Time**
Overbaked by 5+ min OR not enough fat/sugar	Pull cakes right at 200°F-205°F / 93°C-96°C; wrap cooled layers in plastic wrap

Tough, Rubbery & Tunnel-Holed	
Primary Chemical / Oven Cause	**How to Prevent It Next Time**
Overmixed batter after adding flour (excess gluten developed)	Fold dry ingredients in by hand or on lowest mixer speed just until combined

Sticks to Bottom of Pan	
Primary Chemical / Oven Cause	**How to Prevent It Next Time**
Cooled too long in pan (sugars cement) OR un-parchmented bottom	Always trace a parchment circle for the bottom; invert after 10-12 min rest

Blueberries / Choc Chips Sank	
Primary Chemical / Oven Cause	**How to Prevent It Next Time**
Thin batter OR wet heavy mix-ins	Toss berries/chips in 1 tbsp dry flour from recipe before folding in

PRO TIP: Room-temperature butter means 65°F-68°F (cool to the touch). Cream butter and sugar well, then mix flour gently just until combined.